I'm a new Product Manager at Instagram

My manager tasked me with **boosting traffic to individual creator profiles** to increase their **visibility and engagement**. The focus is on empowering creators while **driving platform growth.**

traffic can be two -visit on profile and view on contend of individual creator- We will Aim for view on contend

First we will understand creator market and Competition for Instagram

Global Market 2024	creators worldwide	CAGR
USD 189.74 B	303 M	22.7%

Revenue Streams: Top-earning creators **making $150K+** have an average of **7 revenue streams**, underscoring the need for diversification. Creators earning under **$100K** rely on 2 streams.
Platform Impact: Instagram commands **high rates for Reels and Live content**, with over 50% of creators with 100K+ followers charging $1,000+ per post.
AI Adoption: **84% of creators use AI tool**s, with 75% of marketers increasing spending on AI-generated content in 2023. **AI content drives 2-5x more engagement** than traditional content.
Engagement and Earnings: Creators earning **over $250K** report the highest **satisfaction (score 7.9)**, while those making under **$10K** have lower satisfaction **(score 6.5 or less)**.
Income Distribution: A **majority** of creators **earn less than $500/month**, with only 25% earning over $2,000/month.

Audience Ownership: Creators are using **personal websites, membership groups, and exclusive** channels to connect directly with their audiences.

Instagram vs. Top 4 Platforms for Creators

Competitor	Unique Strengths	Challenges for Creators
Instagram	**High engagement**, visual-first, massive user base.	**Algorithm change**, discoverability issues.
YouTube	Long-form content, **video dominance**, subscriptions	**High production cost/time**; discoverability.
TikTok	**Viral short videos**, high reach for small creators.	**Monetization is weaker** than competitors.
facebook	**Communities** and group , integration with Instagram.	**Aging user base**, lower engagement with younger user
snapchat	Viral short videos, **high reach for small creators**.	**discoverability Limit** beyond friends/connectin

INSTAGRAM CREATOR DISTRIBUTION

- Nano-Influencers (500-5k followers): 54%
- Micro-Influencers (10k–100k followers): 33%
- Top-Tier Creators (1M+ followers): 1%

INSTAGRAM AGE GROUPS:

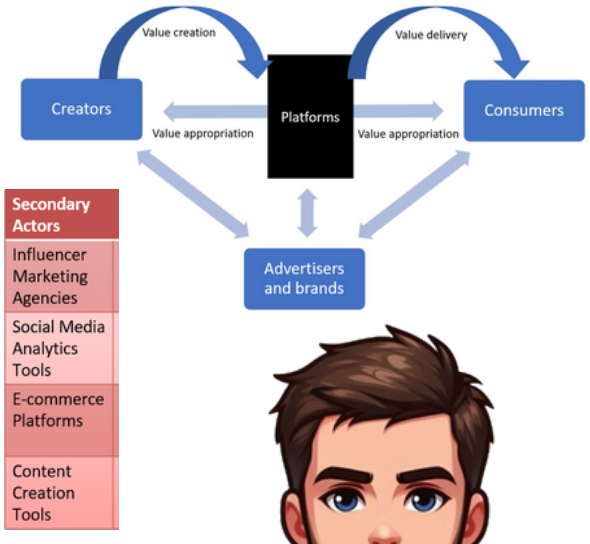
- 18–24 years: 31.7%
- 25–34 years: 30.6%

INSTAGRAM REGIONAL USAGE:

- India: 388.3 M (largest user base).
- United States: 168.75 M.
- Brazil: 137.15 M.

Actors	Constraints
Creators	Struggle to get noticed due to algorithms, too much competition, getting tired from constant posting, limited ways to earn in some areas, and too much dependency on Instagram for income.
Audiences (Followers)	Feel bored with similar content, see too many ads, and find it hard to discover new creators
Brands/Advertisers	Hard to measure success, sometimes choose wrong creators, and can't always afford big influencers.
Instagram (Platform)	Balancing the needs of creators, brands, and users; staying ahead of competitors like YouTube and TikTok

This is how creator economy work's



HYPOTHESYS

(Why Creators Struggle to Get Profile Traffic on Instagram)

- **Not Knowing the Algorithm** 🤯

Creators don't fully understand how Instagram works, leading to low reach and visibility.

- **Content Quality Issues** 🎥

Many struggle to create engaging content that connects with their audience.

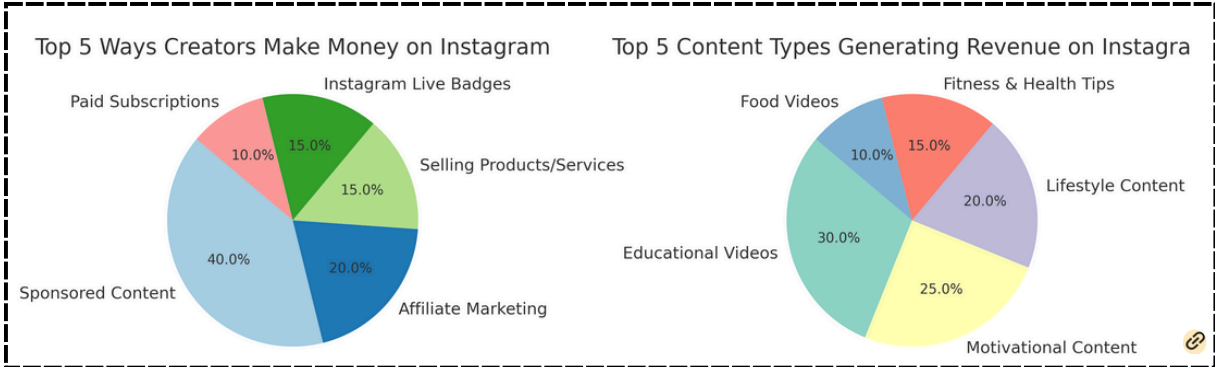
- **Losing Motivation Early** 😞

Slow growth and low engagement make creators give up too soon.

- **Stagnant Growth Over Time** 📉

Posting the same type of content leads to fewer new followers and less engagement

Now ,Let's See Current state of Instagram for creators



According to our secondary research

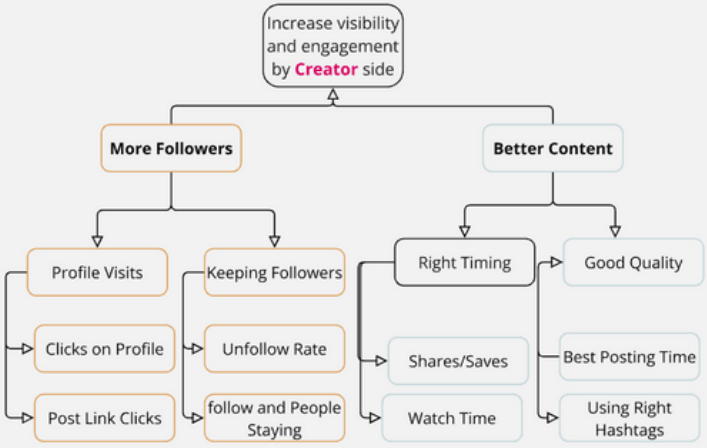
target creator : Growing **Nano Creators** (500-5K followers) in **India** (388.3M users)

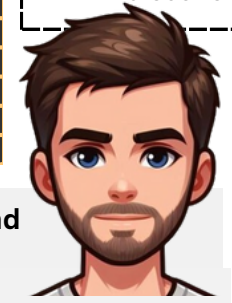
Target User : Engaging **Young Audiences** (62.3% of Instagram's user base) **Age 18-24**

JTBD

When I... use Instagram to explore and enjoy content.
But... the credibility of the content is often questionable, and liking other types of content shifts my feed away from my real interests.
Please help me... get personalized content and credible information tailored to my preferences.
So I... can enjoy my favorite content with trust and discover quality creators on the platform.

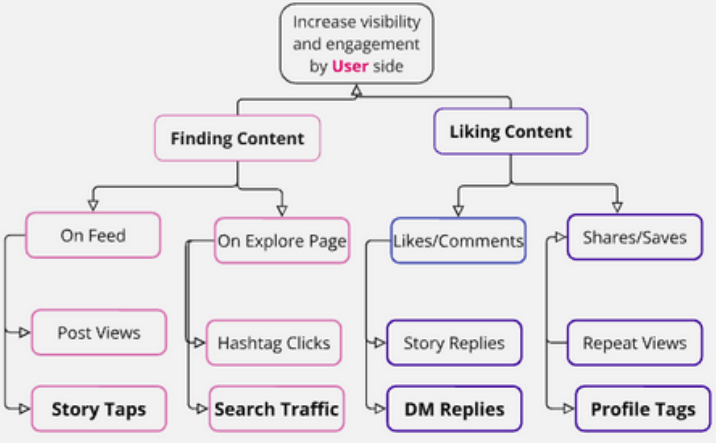
KPI Tree for Creators (Making Better Content 👩‍💻📸)



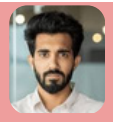


Now , Lets see who are the target creator and user

KPI Tree for Users (Watching and Engaging 👥📱)



User Persona



Name : Kartik Katariya
Age : 26
Location : Akola
Occupation : CA

Kartik, a CA passionate about **learning more on business and CA-related topics**, struggles to stay updated due to his busy schedule. **He turns to Instagram**, finding it a convenient platform that **combines learning and entertainment seamlessly**

Needs

- Kartik wants fast and **easily accessible** content tailored to his interests.
- He values **credible** and trustworthy information.
- He looks for creators who regularly post **high-quality content** related to his desired topics.

Pain Points

- Kartik feels that some posts share **misleading information**.
- He finds it **challenging** to easily **discover content** that matches his **interests** due to the overwhelming amount of content.
- He values quality and is always seeking **high-quality content**.

Name : Yash Chopda
Age : 24
Location : Mumbai
Occupation : Portrait Sketcher

Yash is a portrait sketcher who has a passion for **drawing and sharing his art with the world**. He aims to **earn money by posting his sketches on Instagram** and accepting orders through the platform.

Needs

- Yash wants to **upload his art effectively** to ensure viewers appreciate it.
- He aims to **promote** his art to reach a **larger audience**.
- Yash wants to **earn money** through **monetization** of his art.

Pain Points

- Yash is **unsure how to post content effectively** to get Instagram to prioritize it.
- He **depends on Instagram** too much for exposure.
- Yash feels **anxious** about getting attention due to the **large number of creators** like him.
- He **wants** to get an **initial boost** to gain more visibility.

Problems of Creator

- **Monetization Struggles:** Turning creativity into income isn't always easy.
- **Algorithm Twists:** Constant changes can make or break visibility.
- **Content Overload:** Standing out in a sea of creators is a challenge.
- **Platform Reliance:** Too much dependency can limit growth opportunities

Problems of User

- **Too Much Repetition and contend :**Same type of posts appearing frequently.
- **Fake or Misleading Content:** Difficulty in identifying trustworthy creators.
- **Difficult Navigation :** Struggling to find specific content easily.
- **Algorithm Confusion:** Feeds show what platforms decide, not always what users want.

Let's dive into finding true problem related to user context

(as they are the driving force behind traffic on individual profiles!)

Now , It's time for real problem identification

What is the true problem

Users **want** short, relatable, and **quality** content, **but lots of content** and some **fake or irrelevant** content makes them lose interest. This lowers engagement and **reduces traffic** to individual creator profiles

Users Facing the Problem:

18-25 Year Olds:
Want specific content (e.g., educational, motivational) but **struggle with** content **overload** and **misinformation**

how do we know it is a real problem ?

This problem, framed through **secondary research,** will be **validated next** via user surveys and interviews

WHAT IS THE VALUE GENERATED BY SOLVING THIS PROBLEM?

For Creator

- Increased Visibility and Engagement
- Audience Growth
- Better Monetization Opportunities

For User

- Improved Content Experience
- Time Efficiency
- Enhanced Platform Engagement

Content Overload

- **45%** of users feel **stressed by** having **too much content** on their Instagram feed
- **70%** user prefer more **personalized content** suggestions

52% find it **hard to verify** the **credibility** of content they consume.

Relatable content

- **70%** user **follow** creator for **relatable content**
- **35%** user **unfollow** for **unrelatable** content and **20%** for **repetitive** content

Would you prefer more personalized content suggestions? 🤔

Survey

Let's validate the above problem with 35 user surveys and 5 interviews

1:1 interviews

23/M Valuable content, strong audience engagement, and a unique personality help creators stand out.

I follow creators who post consistently and maintain high-quality content. **26/F**

24/F Consistency and creativity by reliable content creators

Consistently creating high-quality, unique content. Their original creations. **25/M**

29/M There is an overload of content on the internet, giving people too many choices. Their originality, fresh ideas, and connection with the target audience stand out

Prioritise problem

1. **Users prefer specific content types (70%)**
2. **Misinformation is a key concern (47%)**
3. Users struggle to find relevant content easily (54%)

What will be the Impact of solving this problem (Guesstimate)

Assumption: By solving the problem , we estimate that users will spend an additional **5 to 10 minutes daily on Instagram.**

Ad revenue

User Base (Target 18-34 Age Group in India): ~ **250M users**
Total Ad Impressions:
3 ads/user/day x 250M users x 365 days = **273.75** billion ad impressions annually
Revenue for Instagram (assuming **$0.50 CPM**):
Total Revenue for Instagram = 273.75B impressions ÷ 1,000 x $0.50 = **$136.88M** annually
Creators' Share = $136.88M x **50%** = **$68.44M** annually

Monetization revenue

Total nano creators: 200 million
Only 10% of nano creators get sponsored posts , **20 million sponsored more posts per year**
Average earnings per Post = $30
Total Earnings for Creators = 20M posts x $30 = **$600 million** annually
Instagram's Share = $600M x **30%** = **$180 million** annually
Net **creators' Earnings** = **$420 million** annually

By addressing this problem, Instagram can boost its **ad revenue** by **$68.44M annually** and its **monetization revenue** by **$180M annually**.

Possible Solutions

Trust Badge System

What It Is:

A **credibility system where Instagram assigns Trust Badges to** educational, business, and news **content based on engagement and reporting patterns**. These badges indicate reliability, helping users identify trustworthy content at a glance. Unlike likes or comments, **trust badges are system-generated** based on factors like positive engagement, low report rates, and verified sources

Why This Works:

Users struggle to find credible content amid misinformation. The **trust badge** system **provides an authenticity** indicator, guiding users toward reliable content and encouraging creators to maintain quality. This enhances user trust and keeps them engaged longer

How It Can Make Money:

- **More Engagement:**
- **Paid Verification:** Creators may pay to get their content reviewed and earn trust badges faster
- **Better Ads:** More time spent , more ads viewed

Benefits for Users:

- **Find Reliable Content:** Easily know which posts can be trusted
- **Better Experience:**
- **Save Time:** Avoid fake or misleading content

Benefits for Instagram:

- **User Retention:** Trusted content keeps users on the app
- **Improve Content Quality:**
- **Brand Trust:** Positions Instagram as a reliable platform for credible information

Personalized Content Hub

What It Is:

A **dedicated section on Instagram where users can filter and watch specific types of content** like business, food, movies, music, or motivation. This section allows users to **customize their feed** based on their interests, helping them easily find relevant and high-quality content. The existing feed and reels sections remain unchanged, and the Trust Badge feature can also be applied here to highlight credible content

Why This Works:

Users often feel overwhelmed by too much content and struggle to find what interests them. **A personalized content hub offers a focused browsing experience**, improving user satisfaction and increasing time spent on the app

How It Can Make Money:

- **Targeted Ads:** Brands can place more relevant ads based on user preferences in this section
- **Premium Filters:** Offer advanced filtering options as a paid feature
- **Sponsored Content:** Businesses can promote their content to users interested in specific categories

Benefits for Users:

- **Focused Browsing:**
- **Better Experience:**
- **Customization:** Users have control over what they see

Benefits for Instagram:

- **Higher Engagement:**
- **Stronger Retention:**
- **Better Data Insights:**

Finally Its time for Solution

Too much to read ?

Do read for complete understanding

Or else, you can go with highlighted text

More solutions by creator side

- **AI-Powered Content Guidance**

An AI tool that gives creators personalized suggestions on what to do and avoid when creating and posting content. It analyzes trends, audience preferences, and engagement patterns to help new creators improve their visibility on Instagram

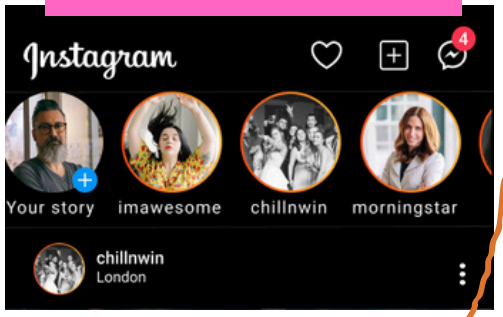
- **AI-Powered Trend Insights**

A feature that provides creators with real-time insights on trending topics, hashtags, and content styles based on their niche. This helps creators stay relevant and create content that resonates with their audience

- **Collaboration Hub**

A dedicated space where creators can find and connect with other creators for collaborations based on shared interests, audience overlap, and content style, helping them grow their reach and engagement

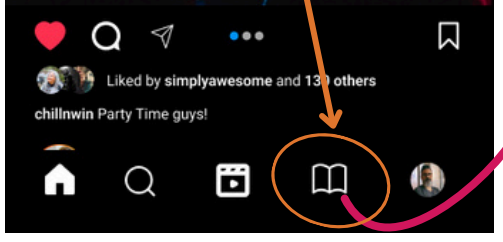
Personalized Content Hub

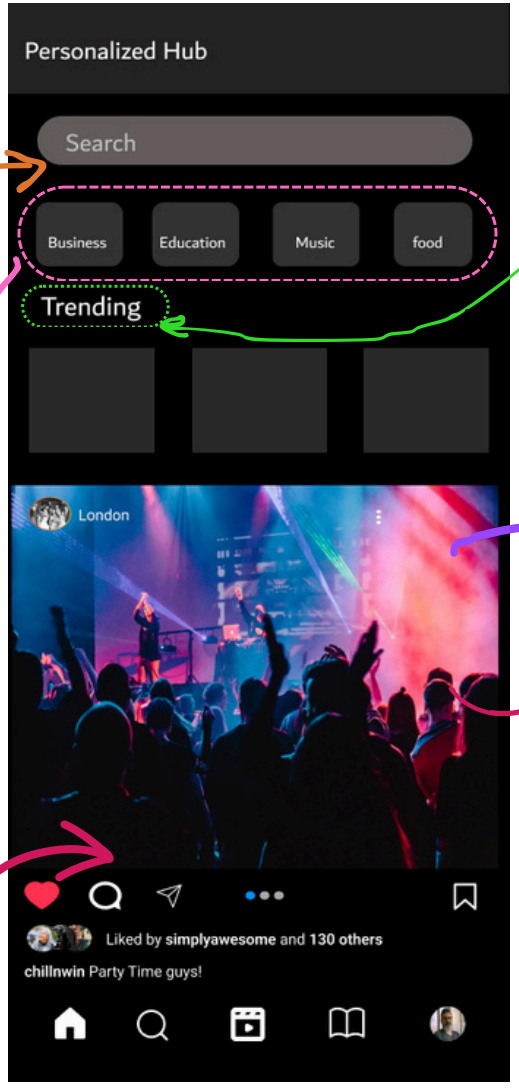


A **search bar to look up specific content types**. Users can select more refined content categories (e.g., t-shirt printing business, English songs) to ensure only the selected type of content is displayed in feed

After searching for a content type, **users can save their top 4 choices on the screen**. These can be deleted at any time, allowing quick navigation to their favorite content based on their mood.

This is the main page of Instagram when the app is opened, where an **icon represents the "Personalized Content Hub" section**

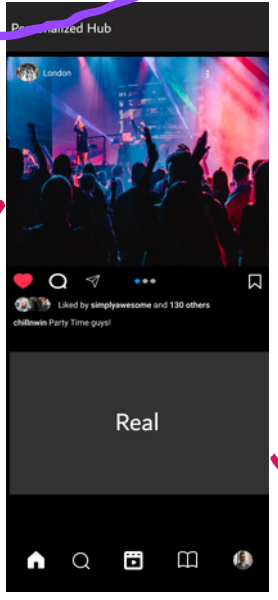




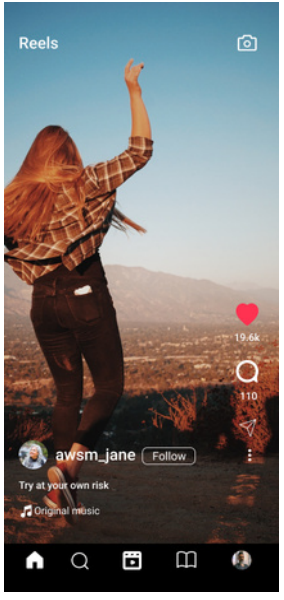
Here, **users can view the top trending creators** of the week, determined by Instagram's system using AI or internal analysis. **This selection is based on creators who received positive responses and trust badges for their posts**, reels, or content. The trending creators displayed will be tailored to the content types chosen by the user in their top 4 selections above

detailed wireframe of the solution

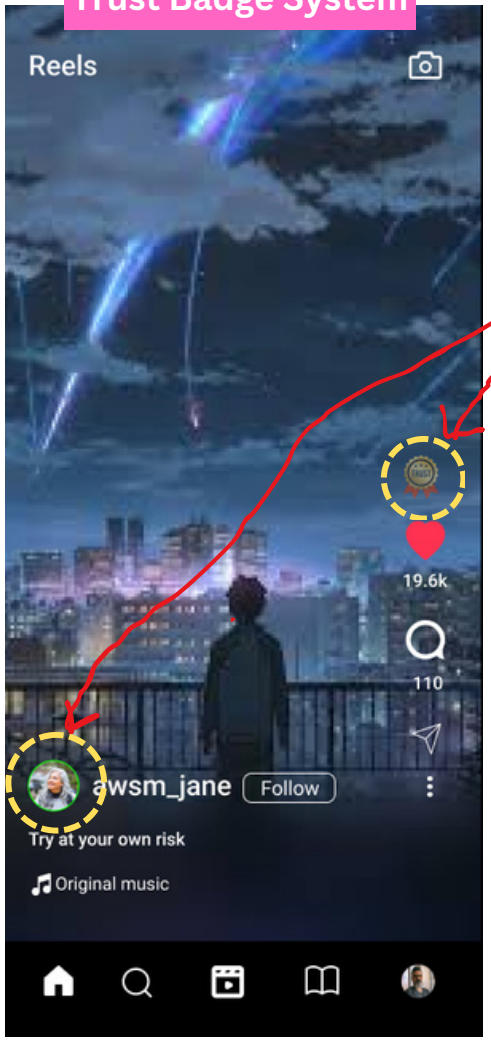
This is the same as home section of instagram , user can see all reels , post ad which user can see in home section , after scrolling screen will look as similler as home section with specific content



After double-tapping, it opens directly in the Reels section, showing content based on the chosen content type.

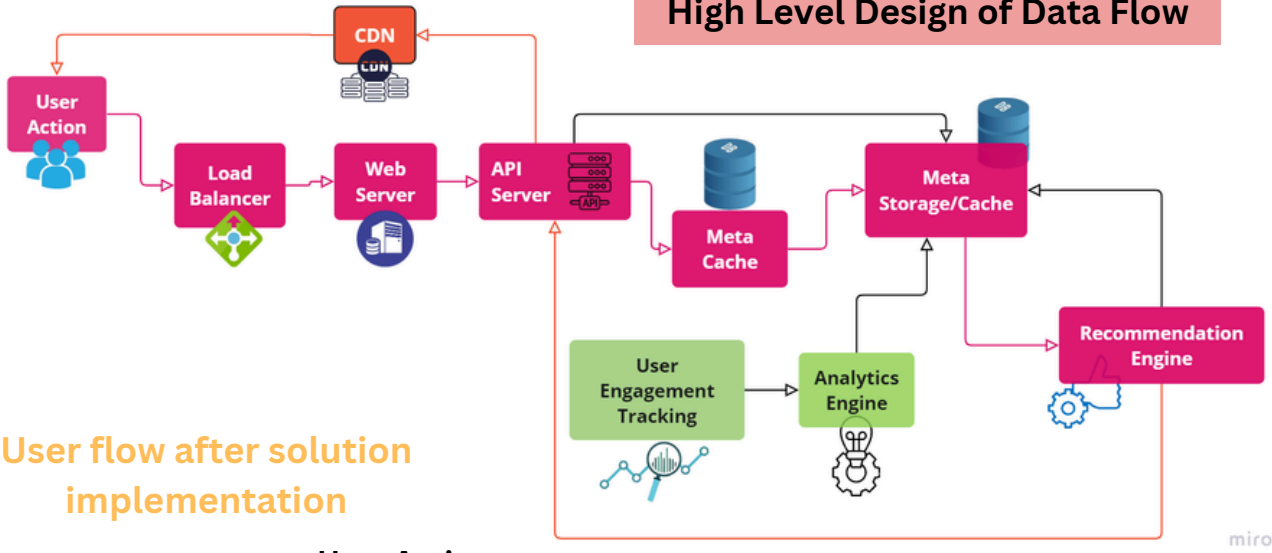


Trust Badge System



A green circle around the profile picture and a trust badge icon together indicate the trusted post

High Level Design of Data Flow



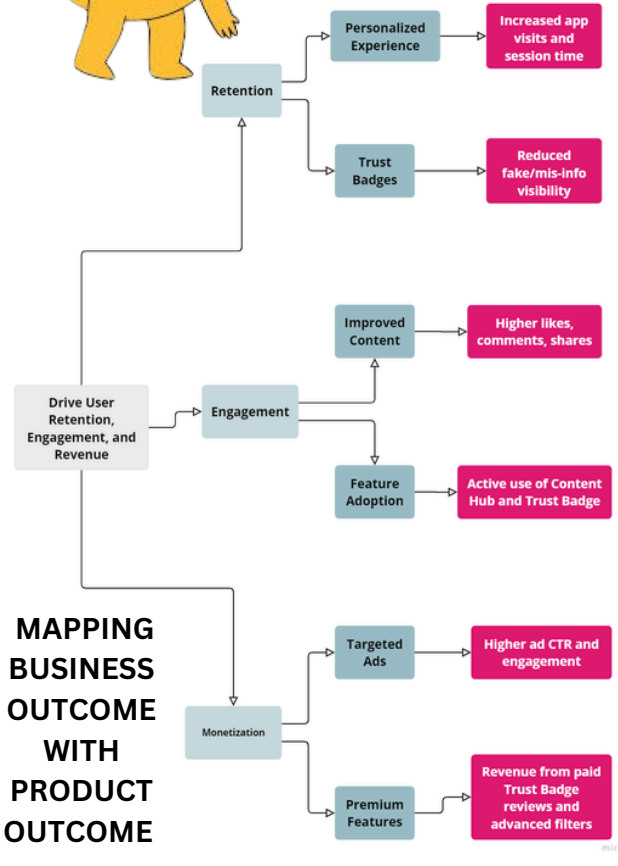
User flow after solution implementation

Stage	User Action	Emotion
Exploration	Logs into Instagram, curious about updates.	Curious
Onboarding	Clicks the banner and selects content preferences.	Excited
Personalized Feed	Returns to the home feed or switches to reels for entertainment.	Engaged
Creator Discovery	Notices recommended creators or trending accounts.	Inspired
Interaction & Trust	Likes, comments, or shares posts; notices posts with a Trust Badge.	Confident
Retention	Continues using the app regularly with updated preferences	Satisfied

Let's Talk About User Flow and Data Flow for Solution

Bye

Final slide for behind the scenes of proposed solution



MAPPING BUSINESS OUTCOME WITH PRODUCT OUTCOME

North Star Metric: Content Hub Retention Rate

The percentage of users who explore the Content Hub and return to use it consistently after 7, 30, or 90 days.

Category	Key Metric	Description
User Retention	Reactivation Rate	Percentage of previously inactive users who return and use the new feature.
User Engagement	Feature Usage Frequency	Average number of sessions per week in the Content Hub or with Trust Badge posts.
Monetization	Ad Revenue Growth from Content Hub	Increase in ad revenue generated specifically from the Content Hub.
Credibility	Report Rate on Trusted Content	Reduction in reports for content with Trust Badges compared to non-badged posts.
User Satisfaction	Net Promoter Score (NPS)	Measure how likely users are to recommend Instagram after using the new features.
Overall Growth	Content Hub Adoption Rate	Percentage of active users exploring and interacting with the new Content Hub.

🚨 Potential Pitfalls of the New Feature and Risks to Address

Hamper the Innovation 💡

Risk: Focusing too much on trust may limit new ideas and push creators to competitors.
Impact: Instagram could lose creativity and users.

Trust Badge Overdependence 🏷️

Risk: Users may only trust badged creators; fees could push out smaller creators.
Impact: Bigger gap between big and small creators

Creator Fallout 🧑‍🎨

Risk: Some creators may feel left out and leave.
Impact: Less variety in content.

Uneven Creator Dynamics 📈📉

Risk: Big creators get all the attention; smaller ones struggle.
Impact: Small creators lose motivation, unique content is missed.